

Morgana Run Trail Sparks New Home Construction - RTC TrailBlog - Rails-to-Trails Conservancy

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When the Slavic Village neighborhood of Cleveland, Ohio, welcomed the [Morgana Run Trail](#) more than five years ago, there were high hopes for how it would help transform the area. And in the ensuing years the trail proved the catalyst for many wonderful amenities, from public art installations to the construction of a new school.

The fall of 2011 brought yet another step forward in Slavic Village's renewal, with construction beginning on a new residential development, [Trailside at Morgana Run](#). The two- and three-bedroom single-family homes will feature direct access to the Morgana Run Trail, which runs throughout Slavic Village to Mill Creek Falls.

With the real estate market struggling nationwide, and in Cleveland particularly, the fact a home developer has invested in a new project deliberately featuring trail access is significant. Recent studies by the National Association of Homebuilders found that [trails were the number one amenity](#) desired by

potential new homebuyers. And homes in close proximity to the Minuteman Bikeway and Nashua River Rail Trail in Massachusetts have been found to consistently sell closer to the list price, and faster, than homes not close to either trail.

Rails-to-Trails Conservancy staff from the Midwest Regional Office have been working with Slavic Village Development (SVD) for the past three years. The 2011 [Urban Pathways Initiative](#) Conference was held in Cleveland in the spring of 2011 and showcased the Morgana Run Trail and Slavic Village. Trailside at Morgana Run is further evidence that walking and biking infrastructure continues to be a robust driver of economic activity.

Where the new neighborhood will one day grow was once an environmentally contaminated brownfield site until being cleaned up a few years ago. Third Federal Savings and Loan, a banking institution founded in Slavic Village and headquartered next door to Trailside, is the developer of Trailside at Morgana Run.

"We want to continue to help the revitalization of the neighborhood where we were founded," says Jennifer Rosa, public relations manager for Third Federal. "The Trailside project is important to us not only because it is on property adjacent to our headquarters, it is also adjacent to a beautiful multi-purpose trail and helps move new development further into the neighborhood."

Photo of cyclists on the Morgana Run Trail by RTC

Posted [Mon, Dec 5 2011 12:30 PM](#) by [Jake Lynch](#)